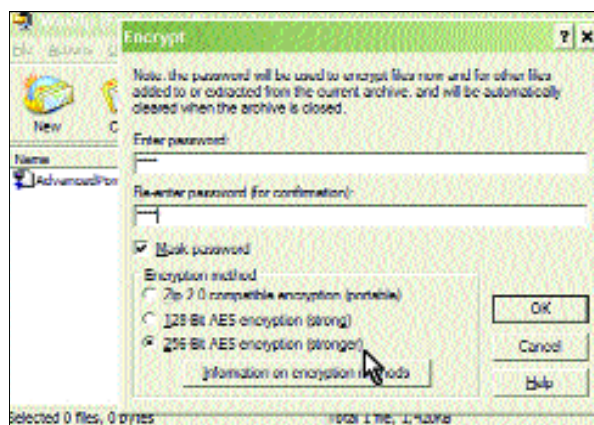




Encrypt your files in WinZip with 256-bit AES

by the US Government's National Institute of Standards (NIST).

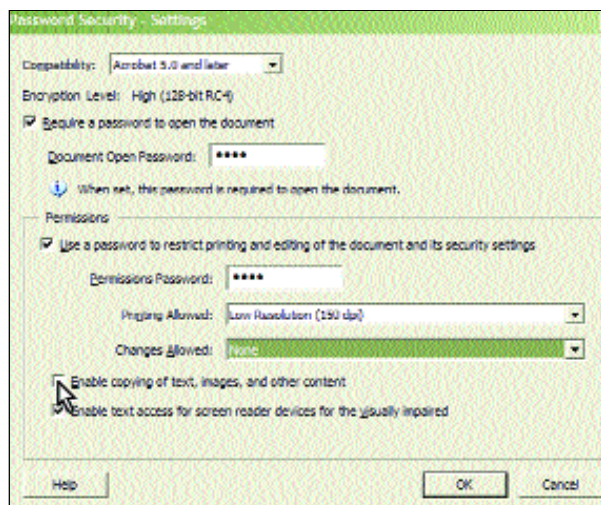
WinZip has three encryption options—standard, 128-bit AES and 256-bit AES. The less secure standard version is compatible with other applications and older WinZip versions. The most secure 256-bit AES has high encryption and decryption times.

To create an encrypted zip file in WinZip, create a new archive by going to **File > New Archive**. Enter the filename, and press OK. An 'Add' dialog box will pop up. Select the files you want to add, and click OK. After this, go to **Actions > Encrypt**, select the desired encryption, enter your password, and click OK.

Although you need a password to access files in a protected Zip file, the password is not required for deleting or replacing files from, or in, the file.

Jack of all trades

Portable Document Format (PDF), is another popular way of distributing docu-



Limit writing to a PDF document using Acrobat 6 Professional

ments. You can set up different password levels while creating PDF documents using Adobe Acrobat Professional. You can also limit editing, printing and even copying for a PDF document.

To do so, open the PDF file and go to **Document > Restrict Opening and Editing**. In the Password Security dialog box, select the Acrobat version to open the PDF. To set a password to open the file, tick 'Require a password to

open the document' and enter it.

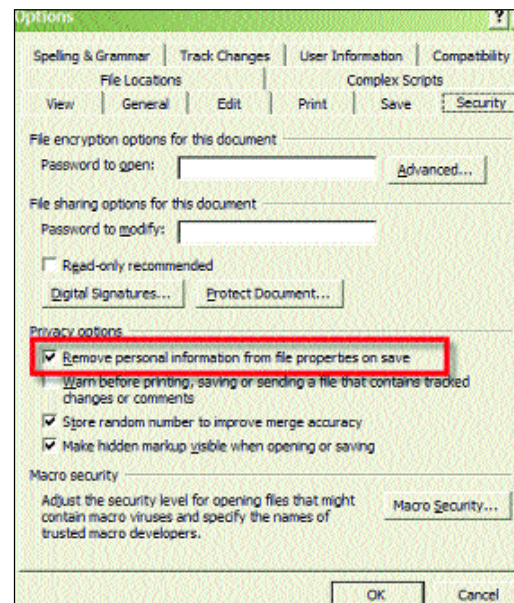
To restrict editing, copying and printing, enable the relevant checkboxes and enter the passwords. Here, as you'll see, you can set other options as well.

Secure Office

Use the common, humble password to securing Microsoft Office documents. In Word, Excel, or PowerPoint, go to **Tools > Options > Security**. You'll see two fields to enter a password for the open file. You can set passwords to open and modify. If you click 'Read Only' when asked for the password, the file opens in that mode, and the original file can't be altered. The passwords here are ciphers used by the encryption algorithm. For better encryption, click Advanced, and choose the algorithm you want from the list.

Word stores detailed information, known as metadata behind the scenes about every document it creates. Although metadata is stored to maintain a history of files and aid in searching and retrieving documents, it can become a privacy issue. However, it ensures that proprietary information is not separated from the document. To see what kind of information is stored in Word files, simply open one in Notepad. You'll find information about the file's author and the path to where the file was stored.

To ensure that this data is removed while saving files, go to **Tools > Options**, and click on Security. Tick 'Remove personal information



Remove personal information from Word documents before distributing them

from file properties on save', and click OK. Changes apply only to the current file. Hence, do this for every file.

To remove all metadata, locate the file in Windows Explorer, right-click, and click Properties. Delete all the information in the Summary tab. There are many more hidden things such as 'track changes', comments and hidden text in Word that need to be removed for total privacy. To show all comments and changes tracked, go to **View > Markup**. To show hidden text, go to **Tools > Options**, switch to the View tab, and enable 'Hidden Text'.

Saving previous versions is useful when you want other versions embedded in the same document. However, Word also saves information about who saved the document. To remove this, go to **File > Versions**. Click the version from the list, and then Delete.

Another feature that might infringe on your privacy is the Fast Save feature, enabled by default. Open a Word document using the Recover Text from any file method explained earlier and you may see information deleted from the file. To disable Fast Save, go to **Tools > Options**, click the Save tab, and remove the checkmark Allow fast saves.

When recording a macro, its header begins with something like:

'Macro1 Macro

'Macro recorded 3/31/2004 by Upen-dra Singhai

To delete this, press **[Alt] + [F11]** to invoke the Visual Basic editor. Double-